

User Guide

Your Company, Your CAD Standards

Version 1.0

SOLIDWORKS Add-in

Developed in Sweden

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1. What Is ComplianceWorks?

ComplianceWorks is a SOLIDWORKS add-in that keeps every engineer working from the same set of company CAD standards, without anyone having to remember what those standards are. It lives in a task pane docked inside SOLIDWORKS and gives you:

- **Design Guidelines** - a checklist of company modeling/drawing rules for the document type you have open, so you know what to verify before releasing a file.
- **Quick Check** - an automated compliance scan that inspects the active document against dozens of rules and gives it a pass/fail score.
- **Utilities** - one-click tools for common cleanup and release tasks (rebuild-and-save, PDF export, dangling dimension cleanup, and more).
- **News, Resources, and Custom Macros** - company announcements, shared links/documents, and company macros, all one click away.
- **Push Messages** - mandatory pop-up notices for things everyone needs to see.

> **Centrally managed**
> All of this content - the guidelines, the settings baseline, the news, the macros - is centrally managed by an administrator and kept in a single database file in a shared folder on the company server. You never edit anything yourself; you just import that file once.

2. How It Works

ComplianceWorks is built around one simple idea: **one admin configures it, everyone else just imports it.**

Step	What happens
1. Control Panel	An administrator opens the (password-protected) Control Panel, adds the company's license key, and defines the company's design guidelines, SOLIDWORKS settings baseline, required custom properties, macros, resources, news, and utilities.
2. Shared folder	Everything - including the license - is saved in a single database file (.json) in a shared folder on the company server. Company macros (.swp) are kept in a shared folder too, for example a Macros folder next to the database. Every engineer needs read access to these folders.
3. Import	Each engineer goes to Tools ▸ ComplianceWorks ▸ Import Database once and selects that file in the shared folder - not a copy of it, which would never receive later changes.
4. Live use	From then on, the task pane, Quick Check, and every utility all read from that same file - everyone is checking their work against the same standard.

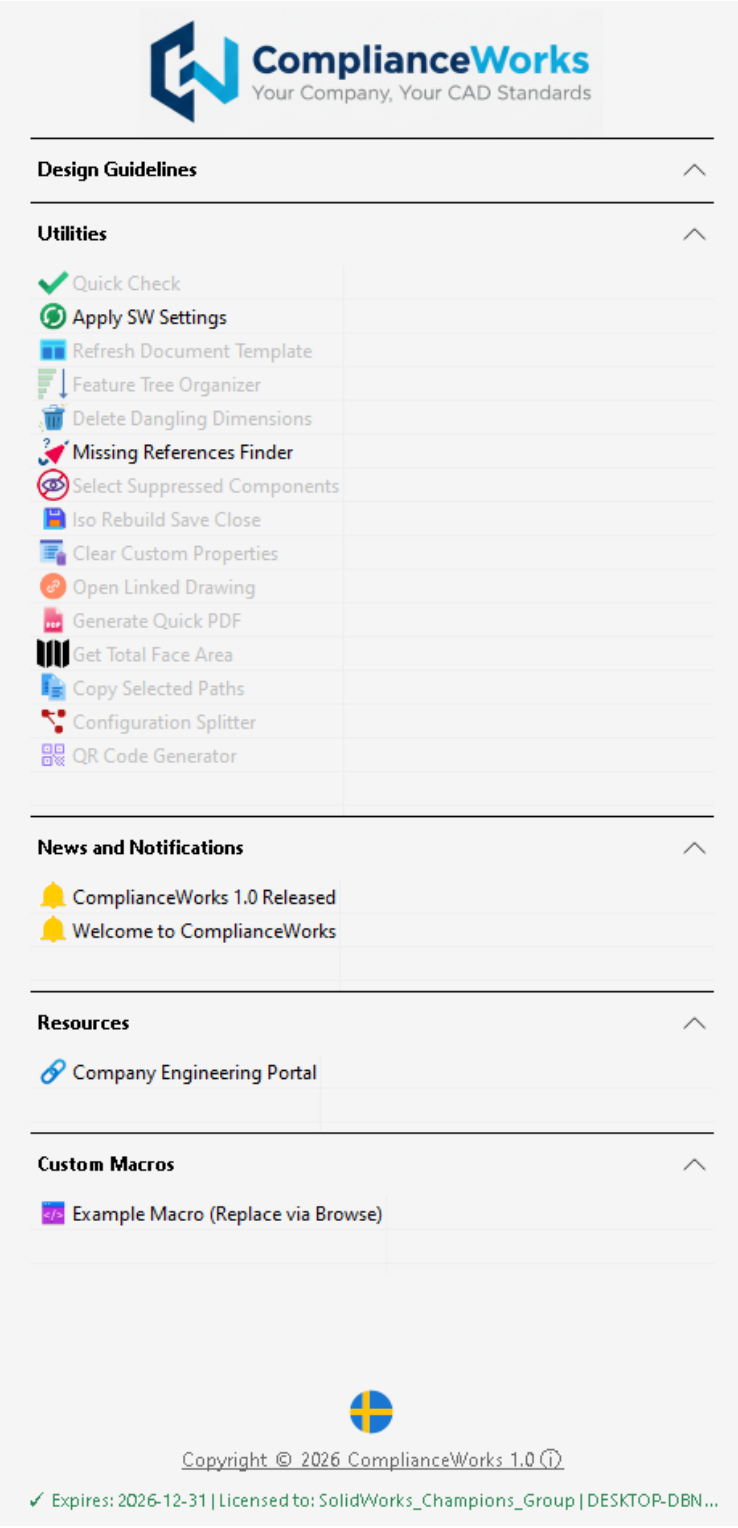
When the administrator updates the shared database, engineers get the changes the next time SOLIDWORKS starts - or straight away with Tools ▸ ComplianceWorks ▸ Refresh Connection. If you are sent a new database file instead, import it with Import Database. Nothing is ever reinstalled.

3. Getting Started

1. Open SOLIDWORKS. ComplianceWorks loads automatically and docks its task pane on the right-hand side (look for the ComplianceWorks icon in the task pane tab strip).
2. If this is your first time using the add-in, go to Tools ▸ ComplianceWorks ▸ Import Database, browse to the database file your administrator gave you, and select it. You'll see a confirmation that the database was imported and set as active.
3. ComplianceWorks then loads the database and checks your company's license (see Section 9). If the task pane shows a message instead of its content - for example Database not available or No valid license - the reason is shown right below it, together with what to do. Problems that can solve themselves (no network or VPN yet, all seats in use) are retried automatically every minute.
4. Open a part, assembly, or drawing. The task pane populates automatically - Design Guidelines shows only the guidelines relevant to the document type you have open (Part / Assembly / Drawing); Utilities, News, Resources, and Custom Macros are always available.
5. That's it - you're set up. The database path is remembered (also when SOLIDWORKS is updated), so this only needs to be done once per computer, or again if your administrator gives you a different database file.

4. The Task Pane

The task pane is organized into five sections. Each section header has an up/down arrow button so you can collapse sections you don't need and give more room to the ones you do.



The ComplianceWorks task pane, docked in SOLIDWORKS

4.1 Design Guidelines

A checklist of the company's modeling and drawing rules that apply to the type of document you currently have open. Guidelines are automatically filtered - a Part-only guideline won't show up while you're working in a Drawing, and vice versa.

- Check off each guideline once you've verified your model/drawing follows it. Your checked/unchecked state is remembered.
- Click a guideline to open its full detail - a description and any rich-text guidance the administrator has written, alongside its severity.
- Each guideline has one of three severity levels, matching the colour of its entry:

Severity	Meaning	Colour
Critical	Must be resolved - a stop-ship issue if left unchecked.	**Red**
Major	Should be resolved - a real standards violation if left unchecked.	**Orange**
Minor	Best-practice - worth doing, lower risk if skipped.	**Green**

Leaving guidelines unchecked also affects your Quick Check score (see Section 5) - Quick Check reports any unchecked guideline for the current document type as part of its compliance scan.

4.2 Utilities

One-click tools that run directly against your active document (or, for a couple of them, against a folder you choose). Tools that change, delete or close something ask you to confirm first; the others run immediately. Every tool reports its result in a message titled with the tool's own name - ✓ when it worked, a warning icon when something needs your attention. Utilities that don't apply to the current document type (for example, a Part-only tool while a Drawing is open) are greyed out; clicking one tells you exactly which kind of document it needs.

See Appendix B for the full list and what each one does. Your administrator can also choose to hide utilities your company doesn't use - if a tool you expect isn't listed, ask your administrator whether it's been disabled.

4.3 News & Notifications

Company announcements pushed out by your administrator. Click an item to open it and read the full notice.

4.4 Resources

Quick links to shared documents, folders, or web pages your administrator has set up (for example, the company standards handbook, a network drive, or an internal wiki page). Click a resource to open it - links open in your browser, folders open in File Explorer, and files open in the application associated with their type. If a resource can't be found, you're told which path is missing.

4.5 Custom Macros

Company-authored SOLIDWORKS macros, ready to run with one click - no need to know where the macro file lives or which procedure to call. Click a macro to run it immediately against the active document. If a macro can't run - for example because the server can't be reached or the macro was moved - ComplianceWorks tells you why.

5. Running Quick Check

Quick Check is ComplianceWorks' automated compliance scan. It inspects the active document against a large set of rules - some universal, some specific to Parts, Assemblies, or Drawings - and gives you a score and a release verdict.

How to run it

6. Open the document you want to check.
7. Click Quick Check in the task pane's Utilities section (or use the Refresh button inside the Quick Check window if it's already open).
8. Quick Check runs through each applicable category and populates a results grid, grouped by category.
9. Review the results, fix anything flagged, and click Refresh to re-check.

Quick Check only reads your document - it never changes it, so it's always safe to run as many times as you like. Running it twice in a row against an unchanged document always gives the same result.

Understanding the results

Each row shows an item name, its value/detail, and a status:

Status shown	What it means
Pass	Compliant - nothing to do.
Critical	Stop-ship issue. Automatically fails the whole document regardless of score.
Major	A real compliance violation - counts heavily against your score.
Minor	A lower-severity issue or best-practice miss - counts lightly against your score.
- (informational)	For your awareness only; doesn't affect the score (for example, a reminder to manually confirm something).

Your score and verdict

Quick Check produces a score from 0–100 and a verdict. The score starts at 100, and each flagged item deducts points based on its severity: Critical −4, Major −2, Minor −0.5 or −1 (some Minor checks weigh a little more than others). Each passing check also adds credit toward the total, so a well-covered document is more resilient to a single flagged item. A document with nothing flagged and nothing passed yet scores 100 by default.

Verdict	Condition	Meaning
APPROVED	Score ≥ 90, and no Critical findings	Good to go.
REVIEW	Score 70–89, and no Critical findings	Usable, but check the flagged items before release.
REJECTED	Score below 70, or any Critical finding present	Fix the issues and re-run before releasing.

> **Note**
> A single Critical finding always results in REJECTED, no matter how high the rest of the score is - some issues (like a broken reference or a rebuild error) are considered too risky to release regardless of everything else being clean.

Exporting a report

Click **Export** to save your results as either an **HTML report** (opens automatically after saving - good for sharing or attaching to an email), or a **CSV file** (good for logging results or importing into a spreadsheet/tracker).

See Appendix A for the full list of what Quick Check inspects.

6. Push Messages

Push Messages are announcements your administrator marks as important enough to interrupt your workflow - they appear automatically as a pop-up the next time you start SOLIDWORKS after one is published, rather than waiting for you to notice them in the News list.

Each pop-up has a “don't show again” option. Leave it unchecked if you want to see the message again next time (for example, if you just want to dismiss it for now), or check it once you've read and don't need the reminder again. Your choice is remembered, also when SOLIDWORKS is updated.

7. The SOLIDWORKS Menu

ComplianceWorks adds a ComplianceWorks menu (under Tools) with four commands:

Command	Who can use it	What it does
Control Panel	Administrators (password-protected)	Opens the full configuration tool described in Section 8.
Import Database	Everyone	Lets you browse to and import/switch to a .json database file - no password required. This is how every engineer connects to (or updates to) the company's current standards. The choice is remembered, also across SOLIDWORKS updates.
Refresh Connection	Everyone	Re-reads the database and re-checks the license without restarting SOLIDWORKS - for example when all seats were in use, the server wasn't reachable when SOLIDWORKS started, or your administrator added a renewed license (see Section 9).
About ComplianceWorks Add-in	Everyone	Shows the version, a summary of the add-in and its features, and where its log file is (for support).

8. Administrator Guide: The Control Panel

> **For administrators**
> This section is for administrators who maintain the company's ComplianceWorks database. Everyday users of the add-in don't need the Control Panel - they only need Import Database (see Section 7).

Open it via Tools ▸ ComplianceWorks ▸ Control Panel. You'll be prompted for the admin password (the title bar shows a remaining-attempts counter after a failed attempt).

Database, license and admin password

Database File, at the very top, shows which database you are editing - the one this computer uses. Browse... next to it opens another database file (the same as Import Database below). If there is no database yet, the first Save Changes asks where to create it; choose a shared folder on the server.

License shows where the license comes from. Click Add License..., paste the license key you received from ComplianceWorks and click OK - Load from File... in the same window accepts a .cwlic file instead. The window shows straight away who the license is for, the number of seats and the last valid day; an invalid or expired key is refused. Click Save Changes: the license is then stored in the database itself, so the database is the only file on the server and every user picks the license up automatically. License Status shows how many seats are in use right now - hover over it to see who is using them.

A license can be locked to your shared database folder (the Add License window shows it). It then only works for the database in that folder - a copy of the database somewhere else, for example on someone's own computer, is refused. If your database moves to another folder or server, ask ComplianceWorks for a new key.

From 30 days before the license's last valid day, License Status turns orange as a reminder to renew - every user's task pane shows the same reminder.

Manage Password (bottom right) sets, changes or removes the admin password. Every password entry is masked. To remove the protection, leave the new password empty and confirm; cancelling at any step changes nothing.

The seven tabs

Tab	What you configure there
Design Guidelines	The checklist rules shown in the task pane. Each guideline has an ID, title, description, rich-text detail, a document-type filter (Part/Assembly/Drawing), and a severity: Critical, Major, or Minor.
Utilities	Which of the built-in utilities (see Appendix B) are visible to engineers. Quick Check is always shown and can't be hidden.
News and Notifications	Company announcements shown in the task pane's News section.
Push Messages	Announcements that pop up automatically on startup (see Section 6).

Tab	What you configure there
Resources	Shared links and file paths shown in the task pane's Resources section.
Custom Macros	Company macros, shown in the task pane's Custom Macros section. Put each macro (.swp) in a shared folder on the server that every engineer can read - for example a Macros folder next to the database - and select it there with Browse...; a macro on your own drive gets a warning, because colleagues cannot run it from there. The Method list then shows the macro's procedures as Module.Procedure, the same list as Method in SOLIDWORKS' Customize Macro Button dialog - choose the one to run, usually main.
SolidWorks Settings	The compliance baseline used by Quick Check's SW Settings Compliance category - see below.

SolidWorks Settings tab, in detail

This tab captures a snapshot of your SOLIDWORKS installation's settings to use as the company baseline. Three independent checkboxes control what gets captured:

- **Include System Options** - captures your current SOLIDWORKS system options (units, colours, display settings, and so on) as the baseline every engineer's Quick Check will be compared against.
- **Include File Locations** - captures your configured File Locations paths (templates, libraries, etc.) as the baseline, so Quick Check can flag engineers whose paths have drifted from the standard.
- **Include Required Custom Properties** - reads your Part/Assembly/Drawing templates and captures which custom properties are required at the document level and the configuration level. This is what powers Quick Check's Custom Properties category. Unlike System Options and File Locations (applied via Apply SW Settings), captured custom properties are applied to documents via Refresh Document Template.

Saving, importing, and exporting

- **Save Changes** writes the item you're editing - or a new license, Utilities or SolidWorks Settings change - straight to the database file. Saving is safe against network drops: the new content goes to a temporary file first and only then replaces the database. Engineers get the change the next time SOLIDWORKS starts, or with Refresh Connection.
- **Import Database** loads an existing .json database file into the Control Panel for editing (for example, to update a database you built previously, or to take over from another administrator). If you have unsaved changes, you're asked before they're discarded.
- **Export Database** writes a copy of the database to a .json file - for a backup, or to move the database to another server. Engineers should import the database in the shared folder itself, not a copy: a copy never receives your later changes.

- **Create New** starts a new item on the current tab with the next free ID. The very first save on a computer that has no database yet asks where to create the database file - choose a shared folder on the server; a folder on your own drive gets a warning, because colleagues cannot reach it.
- **Selecting several items** - Shift+click, Ctrl+click or Ctrl+A in the list. Delete Content or the Delete key removes them all (after you confirm).
- **Move Up / Move Down** change the order items appear in the task pane; click Save Changes to store the new order.
- **Sorting** - click a column header. IDs sort by number (DG-2 before DG-10).
- **Unsaved changes are never lost silently** - switching to another item, creating a new one, importing or closing the Control Panel asks you first, and an unfinished item is kept when you switch tabs.
- **Two administrators at once** - if someone else saved the database while you had the Control Panel open, Save tells you and asks: Yes saves your version (theirs is replaced), No loads their version (your unsaved changes are discarded).
- **Database not available** - if the database cannot be read when the Control Panel opens (server down, no permission, damaged file), it opens view-only, so it can never save an empty database over the shared one. Import Database still works.
- **Insert Image** (in the text toolbar) places a picture at the cursor and keeps all existing formatting. Large pictures are scaled down so the shared database stays small.

Adding a different license re-checks the license when you save. Changing content only (guidelines, news, macros, settings, etc.) re-applies immediately without a license check.

9. Licensing

ComplianceWorks uses an on-premise license: a license key that your company receives from ComplianceWorks (by e-mail, or as a .cwlic file). Your administrator adds it in the Control Panel and it is stored in the company's ComplianceWorks database. No internet connection is needed. The license states the company name, the number of seats and the last day it is valid. It is digitally signed, so it cannot be edited - a changed key is simply refused.

Floating seats. The number of seats is the number of people who can use ComplianceWorks at the same time, on any computer - 8 seats means up to 8 people at once. A seat is taken when SOLIDWORKS starts with ComplianceWorks loaded and is released as soon as SOLIDWORKS is closed. If a computer crashes, loses its network connection or goes to sleep, its seat is released automatically after 15 minutes.

Setting it up (administrators). Put the database in a shared folder on the company server, open the Control Panel, click Add License..., paste the license key and click Save Changes - see Section 8. ComplianceWorks keeps track of the seats in a ComplianceWorks_Seats folder next to the database: every ComplianceWorks user needs Modify permission on that folder (read access to the database itself is enough).

Only for your company's database. A license can be locked to the shared folder where your database is kept. It then only works for the database in that folder - a copy of the database somewhere else, or the key pasted into a database on a home computer, is refused. Older databases that point to a separate .cwlic file keep working; the Control Panel stores that license in the database the next time it saves.

When the license can't be used, the task pane shows No valid license with the reason below it, and a message explains what to do:

Message	What to do
All N seats are in use	Everyone the license allows is already working - the message lists who. ComplianceWorks keeps trying every minute and starts by itself as soon as a seat is free. If it happens often, ask your administrator about more seats.
The license file could not be reached	(Older databases with a separate license file) This computer can't reach the server. ComplianceWorks keeps trying every minute and connects by itself once the server can be reached.
The license expired on ...	Ask your administrator to add the renewed license key in the Control Panel.
The license in the database is not valid	The stored license is damaged. Ask your administrator to add the license key again.
A license seat could not be reserved	Your account can't write to the ComplianceWorks_Seats folder. Ask IT for Modify permission on it.
No license has been added	Your administrator hasn't added the license key in the Control Panel yet.

Message	What to do
The license file was not found	(Older databases with a separate license file) It was moved, renamed or deleted. Ask your administrator to add the license key in the Control Panel.
No permission to read the license file	(Older databases with a separate license file) Ask IT for read access to the license file, or ask your administrator to add the license key in the Control Panel.
This license is for another folder	The database is not in the folder the license is for - for example a copy of the database. Use the database in the shared folder, or ask ComplianceWorks for a key for the new folder.

After fixing the cause, use Tools ▸ ComplianceWorks ▸ Refresh Connection to try again - there is no need to restart SOLIDWORKS. Problems that can go away by themselves (network or VPN, a seat being freed) are retried automatically every minute for up to four hours, without further messages.

Before the license runs out. From 30 days before the last valid day, the task pane and the Control Panel show an orange reminder with the number of days left, so the renewal can be arranged in time.

10. Troubleshooting & FAQ

The task pane is empty / nothing shows up.

Make sure you've imported a database at least once via Tools ▸ ComplianceWorks ▸ Import Database. If the task pane shows a message instead (Database not available, No valid license, ...), the reason is shown right below it - see Section 9.

The server could not be reached when SOLIDWORKS opened.

The company server wasn't reachable - usually because the network or VPN wasn't connected yet. ComplianceWorks keeps trying every minute and starts by itself once the server answers; to try right away, use Tools ▸ ComplianceWorks ▸ Refresh Connection.

It says all seats are in use.

Every seat is taken by someone currently running SOLIDWORKS with ComplianceWorks. A seat frees up as soon as someone closes SOLIDWORKS (or 15 minutes after a computer crashed or went to sleep). ComplianceWorks keeps trying every minute and starts by itself as soon as a seat is free. If it happens often, ask your administrator about more seats.

The task pane says Database not available.

The database file can't be read, and the reason is shown below the message: the server or VPN isn't connected (ComplianceWorks then keeps trying every minute and loads it by itself), the file was moved or renamed (import it again from its new location), you don't have permission to read it (ask IT), or the file is damaged (ask your administrator to open it in the Control Panel and save it again).

The task pane says the license expires soon.

From 30 days before the last valid day, ComplianceWorks shows an orange reminder. Let your administrator know - they need to get the renewed license key and add it in the Control Panel.

Can someone use our license key at home?

Not when the license is locked to your shared database folder: the add-in then refuses it for a database anywhere else. If your license has no folder lock, ask ComplianceWorks for one.

Where is the log file?

ComplianceWorks keeps a small log of what it does and of any errors in %LOCALAPPDATA%\ComplianceWorks\Logs\ComplianceWorks.log - the exact path is also shown in Tools ▸ ComplianceWorks ▸ About ComplianceWorks Add-in. Your administrator or ComplianceWorks support may ask you for it when something doesn't work.

ComplianceWorks forgot my database after a SOLIDWORKS update.

The database path is now kept across SOLIDWORKS updates. If you're coming from an older ComplianceWorks version, import the database once more with Import Database.

Design Guidelines don't show anything for my document.

Guidelines are filtered by document type - check that any guidelines exist for the type of document you have open (Part/Assembly/Drawing), and that you actually have a document open and active.

A utility is greyed out.

Most utilities only apply to a specific document type (for example, drawing-only tools stay greyed out while a part is active), or no document is open at all. Clicking a greyed-out utility shows a message telling you exactly what it requires. Open the right kind of document and it will become clickable. If it's still greyed out, your administrator may have hidden it from the Utilities tab.

A custom macro says the macro file could not be found.

The macro was moved or renamed, or it is in a folder your computer can't reach - for example on the administrator's own computer. Let your administrator know: the macro belongs in a shared folder on the server, selected again in the Control Panel.

I imported a new database but the task pane still looks out of date.

Design Guidelines and Quick Check both refresh automatically once the import finishes and the license check completes - this usually takes a moment. If something still looks stale, switching to another open document and back (or reopening the document) forces a refresh.

Quick Check flagged something I don't understand.

Every row includes a short explanation in its detail text. For SW Settings Compliance and Custom Properties results specifically, the flagged item reflects your administrator's saved baseline - check with them if you believe the baseline itself is wrong.

I forgot the Control Panel admin password.

Only your administrator can reset this - it's stored in the database itself and isn't recoverable from within the add-in.

Appendix A: Quick Check Category Reference

Runs on every document type

Category	What it checks
File & Save State	Document type, SOLIDWORKS version, save status, file name/size, last modified date, unsaved changes, read-only flag.
Document Language & Units	SOLIDWORKS display language, unit system, linear/angular unit overrides, and drafting standard.
Custom Properties	Document-level and configuration-level custom properties required by the admin's template baseline.
SW Settings Compliance	Your live File Locations and System Options compared against the admin's saved baseline.
Design Guidelines	Any admin-defined guideline for this document type that's still unchecked.

Parts only

Category	What it checks
Model Integrity	Whether the model needs a rebuild, and any rebuild/equation errors.
Sketch Quality	Under-defined and over-defined sketches.
Feature Tree Health	Rebuild errors surfaced anywhere in the feature tree.
Material & Mass	Material assignment, a density sanity check, and mass/volume/bounding box.
Hole Standards	Hole Wizard usage, non-standard drill sizes, and thread standard consistency.
Configuration Health	Cached rebuild state for each configuration (read-only - never activates or rebuilds a configuration itself).

Assemblies only

Category	What it checks
Mate Integrity	Total mate count, mate errors, and redundant mates.
Component References	Broken file references and accidentally suppressed components.
Assembly Structure	Floating, virtual, and lightweight components.
Image Quality	Shaded image quality display setting.
External References	Broken or out-of-date external (in-context) references.
Component Materials	Material assignment and density across all part components in the assembly.
Configuration Health	Same non-destructive check as for Parts, run across the assembly's configurations.

Drawings only

Category	What it checks
Annotation Health	Dangling annotations.
View Integrity	Drawing views that are out of date relative to the model.
BOM Accuracy	Bill of materials rows vs. the model, part numbers, descriptions, and quantities.
Drawing Standards	Sheet format/template location and version, and dimension overrides.
Layer Compliance	Dimensions and notes assigned to the correct layers.

Appendix B: Utilities Reference

Utility	What it does	Requires
Quick Check	Runs the full compliance scan described in Section 5.	Any document
Apply SW Settings	Applies the administrator's standard SW System Options and File Locations to your installation. Asks first.	-
Refresh Document Template	Adds custom properties missing from the master template to the active document (and reloads the sheet format on every sheet of a drawing), then saves it. Asks first.	Any document
Feature Tree Organizer	Renames and standardises feature names in every configuration according to company naming conventions and reports how many were renamed. Asks first.	Part or Assembly
Delete Dangling Dimensions	Deletes all dangling dimensions and annotations from every sheet of the active drawing, then returns you to the sheet you were on. Asks first.	Drawing
Missing References Finder	Scans a folder you choose (including subfolders) and lists missing external references. Unreadable files are counted and skipped; the result can be exported to CSV.	None (works on a folder)
Select Suppressed Components	Selects every suppressed component, at all levels, in the active assembly.	Assembly
Iso Rebuild Save Close	Sets an isometric view, rebuilds, saves, and closes the active part or assembly. If it can't be saved, it stays open and you're told why.	Part or Assembly
Clear Custom Properties	Deletes all document-level and configuration-level custom properties, then saves the document. Asks first.	Any document
Open Linked Drawing	Finds and opens the drawing(s) of the active part or assembly - or of the components selected in an assembly - in its folder and subfolders.	Part or Assembly
Generate Quick PDF	Exports every sheet of the active drawing to a PDF with the same name, in the same folder. Tells you if the previous PDF is still open in a viewer.	Drawing
Get Total Face Area	Calculates the total surface area of all visible bodies in the active part, in the document's units.	Part
Copy Selected Paths	Copies the file path of the active document (or of the selected components in an assembly) to the clipboard, one path per line.	Any document
Configuration Splitter	Saves each configuration of the active part as its own single-configuration .sldprt file in a folder you choose.	Part
QR Code Generator	Generates a QR code from information you choose (file name, path, or custom properties) and inserts it onto the active drawing sheet, or saves it as an image file.	Any document

Your administrator can hide any of these except Quick Check from the Utilities tab in the Control Panel - if one you need isn't visible, ask them to enable it.

ComplianceWorks - Your Company, Your CAD Standards.